

Ian Newman

1499 Laurel Hollow Road
Syosset, NY 11749
516.983.9839
ian.metromet@gmail.co

Senior Public Affairs Leader | Integrated Campaign Strategy | Political & Digital Communications

ian.metromet@gmail.com

(516) 983-9839

[Portfolio](#)

[LinkedIn](#)

Objective: Bilingual public affairs leader with over seven years of experience managing integrated digital-first advocacy campaigns. Focused on advancing media strategies which deliver racial, social and economic justice. Proven background leading cross-functional teams of staff and volunteers managing high-level advocacy campaigns and shaping strategic narratives. Seeking a director or deputy director position to drive policy outcomes for lasting socioeconomic and organizational impact.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

LEAD COMMUNICATIONS SPECIALIST — SEIU 521- REMOTE | 2020 — PRESENT

- Manage deep relationships with journalists at [San Francisco Chronicle](#), [NPR-KQED](#), [SJ Mercury News](#), [NBC](#), [LA Times](#), [SFGate](#) to secure high-impact narratives winning a minimum 6M+ audience.
- Lead integrated media and communications teams of up to 60 member volunteers and staff, supporting fast-moving high-pressure, high-stakes campaigns on behalf of 73,000 workers.
- Coordinate texting and organizing lists for digital and weekly field actions, conducting ongoing data review and list evaluation based on real-time feedback to strengthen targeting and engagement.
- Lead on equitable housing, childcare and education, [racial](#) and [economic justice](#) campaigns, policy initiatives, events, and thought partnerships (e.g. U.S. Rep. Pramila Jayapal, Dolores Huerta, NAACP).
- Drive policy and campaign wins through [earned media](#), Op-Eds, press conferences, [social media](#) and digital storytelling, increasing engagement 55–81% across priority audiences.

COMMUNICATIONS DIRECTOR — UFCW 367, TACOMA, WA — 2019 — 2020

- Represented UFCW 367 communications in 250 person coalition of labor executives, community organizations, affiliate unions, and non-profits across Pacific Northwest (24,000 workers).
- Designed and produced campaign multimedia including endorsement flyers, posters, scripts, and short form documentary to increase audience and advance building racial and economic equity.
- Acted as spokesperson in partnerships with local organizations like NAACP and Democratic Party to support progressive candidates in key municipal and congressional races.
- Managed communication budgets, vendor relationships, and media plans strategically reallocating limited resources to increase audience reach and a 88% increase in membership engagement.

MEDIA/ORGANIZING CHAIR — UAW 2865, SANTA CRUZ, CA — 2017 — 2018

- Led diverse staff team of 8 field organizers and communicators to generate a 75% membership increase through texting, email, and campaign hubs representing 24,000 public employees.
- Led internal boss fight that preserved 500+ union jobs while upholding academic standards.

FREELANCE PHOTOGRAPHER — BROOKLYN, NY/ BERKELEY, CA — 2014 — 2016

- Directed end-to-end commercial photography, pre-production, on-set execution, post-production, logistics and quality control to deliver brand focused visuals on time and on budget.
- Led and coordinated production teams, assistants, and collaborators to ensure efficient workflows and consistent, high-quality deliverables across multiple concurrent shoots.

LEAD ORGANIZER — SEA-SEIU LOCAL 1984, CONCORD, NH — MAY 2011 — MAY 2014

- Developed, planned and implemented successful external and internal organizing drives.
- Provided clear expectations of goals, support and feedback with a central focus on building organizing committees and identifying membership leaders.
- Managed field teams of up to 8 staff members, exceeding targeted campaign goals.

ORGANIZER-IN-TRAINING, SEIU, BROOKLYN, NY— MAY 2010 — MAY 2011

- Transformed emerging workplace leaders into effective organizers through structured training and leadership development and community engagement strategies.
- Achieved majority in card authorization collection by developing organizing committees, tracking progress, and driving turnout in key worksites.
- Collaborated with senior organizers to design campaign strategy, map worksites, and mobilize community allies in support of union recognition.

MEDIA MANAGER—GENTILE FOR BROOKLYN— BROOKLYN, NY— AUG 2009—2010

FIELD ORGANIZER—SCOTT KLEEB FOR U.S. SENATE— LINCOLN, NE—OCT 2008 —JUN 2009

INTERN—U.S. SENATE MAJORITY LEADER HARRY REID—WASHINGTON, DC— 2007 — OCT 2008

EDUCATION

UNIVERSITY OF CALIFORNIA, SANTA CRUZ— JUNE 2018

Master's of Fine Arts (MFA) in Digital Arts and New Media

- Focus: *Sociopolitical Representation in Contemporary Media*
- U.C. Santa Cruz Graduate Fellowship, 2016-2018; 2018 Florence French Fellowship

STATE UNIVERSITY OF NEW YORK, PURCHASE COLLEGE— MAY 2008

Bachelor's of Arts (BA) in Philosophy, Minor in Photography

- Focus: *Political Identity Construction in Contemporary Society*
- Student Teaching Aide, Digital Monitor 2005-2007

SKILLS

Creative & Design

Expertise in Adobe Creative Cloud (Photoshop, InDesign, Premiere Pro, Illustrator, Lightroom), Final Cut Pro, GIMP, DXO Photolab, Pixlr, Capcut, Filmora, Canva Professional. Experience with InfoGRAM, Piktochart, (infographics), Figma, DaVinci Resolve, Blender, VECTR, Inkscape (vector and digital illustration).

Data, Analytics and Digital Engagement

Expertise with Critical Mention, Meltwater, Sprout Social, Hootsuite (press monitoring social media listening), Bitly & Rebrandly, LinkTree, MailChimp, Constant Contact (email & marketing), Survey Monkey (data collection), ElectionBuddy, EveryAction (digital engagement) Meta Ads Manager (Facebook, Instagram, Threads) and Reddit Advertisement Manager. Experience with Google Analytics, SWOT analysis, Salesforce, L2, TargetSmart, StackAdapt/TargetSmart forecasting. Luminate, NGP Voter Access Network (VAN), (CRM), Hustle, TextThru, SpokeText. Experience leveraging AI-assisted tools for workflow optimization, analytics optimization to improve speed, targeting, and message testing.

Web Development

Proficient in HTML 5, JavaScript, jQuery, WordPress, Wix, Squarespace, and Drupal. Proficient in responsive design, content integration, plugin management, SEO analysis, WCAG accessibility standards. Familiar with front-end frameworks and libraries including Bootstrap and Tailwind CSS. Working knowledge of Google Search Console, PageSpeed Insights, schema markup, and security best practices.

Language

Advanced Spanish (speaking, reading, writing).